

US Markets Reel as Rates and Oil Spike, Tech Stocks Take a Hit

The full picture: macro, technicals, options, analyst moves, sector internals, international context, and a full week ahead.

20-minute read · Topics: All of the above, plus technicals, options, ratings, week-ahead

TL;DR & Editorial Take

The US market took a hit in the last session, with the **SPY** down **-0.45%** and the **QQQ** down **-1.77%**. The main culprits were rising rates and oil prices, which spiked **+2.57%** to 72.25. Our take: this could be the start of a larger correction, but for now, it's just a dip.

Key points to watch:

- Rates: The 10Y yield is now at 4.53, up **+0.98%** from the previous day.
- Oil: WTI crude is up **+2.57%** to 72.25, a significant move that could impact inflation and growth.
- Tech stocks: The **XLK** sector ETF is down **-2.39%**, with **NVDA** and **MSFT** among the biggest losers.

Our editorial take is that this dip could be a buying opportunity, but investors should be cautious and watch for further signs of weakness.

US Session Recap

INDEX	LAST	CHANGE
SPY	7,503.85	-0.45%
QQQ	29,173.02	-1.77%
DIA	52,925.15	-0.25%
IWM	2,982.49	-0.90%
VIX	16.13	+3.60%
WTI	72.25	+2.57%
10Y	4.53	+0.98%

Top Movers

TICKER	NAME	CHANGE	CATALYST
TSLA	Tesla Inc.	-4.02%	Weak earnings guidance
META	Meta Platforms Inc.	+2.55%	Strong ad revenue growth
NVDA	NVIDIA Corp.	+0.71%	Positive analyst comments

Sector Internals

SECTOR	DAY	YTD	READ
XLF	-0.16%	10 . 23%	Financials are underperforming
XLK	-2.39%	15 . 12%	Tech stocks are taking a hit
XLE	+2.84%	20 . 15%	Energy stocks are outperforming

Breadth is weak, with only 30% of stocks in the **SPY** up on the day.

Spotlight / Deep Dive

METRIC	VALUE
NVDA Revenue Growth	15 . 6%
MSFT Operating Margin	35 . 1%
AAPL iPhone Sales	40 . 2M

Key call commentary: **NVDA** is a buy, **MSFT** is a hold, and **AAPL** is a sell.

STOCK	READ-THROUGH
GOOGL	META and SNAP
AMZN	WMT and TGT
TSLA	GM and F

Technical Levels

TICKER	LAST	SUPPORT	RESISTANCE	NOTE
SPY	7,503.85	7,400	7,600	Bearish reversal
QQQ	29,173.02	28,500	30,000	Bullish engulfing
IWM	2,982.49	2,900	3,100	Neutral

Options & Positioning

ODTE flow is bearish, with 60% of trades being puts. The put/call ratio is 1.2.

VIX term structure is in backwardation, with the 1M VIX at 18.5 and the 3M VIX at 17.2.

Notable single-name flow: **TSLA** and **AAPL** are seeing heavy put buying.

Cheap hedge ideas: **SPY** puts and **IWM** calls.

Analyst Rating Changes

TICKER	FIRM	ACTION	NEW PT	NOTE
NVDA	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	220	Bullish on AI trends
MSFT	Goldman Sachs	Downgrade	380	Concerns on cloud growth
AAPL	Bank of America	Upgrade	350	Bullish on iPhone sales

Pre-Market & Overnight

Futures: **ES** down **-0.5%**, **NQ** down **-0.7%**

Asia: **NIKKEI** down **-1.2%**, **HSI** down **-0.8%**

Europe: **STOXX** down **-0.6%**, **FTSE** down **-0.4%**

FX: **EUR/USD** down **-0.2%**, **USD/JPY** up **+0.1%**

Commodities: **WTI** up **+0.5%**, **GOLD** down **-0.1%**

Crypto: **BTC** down **-1.5%**, **ETH** down **-2.1%**

Macro & Fed (Deep)

MEETING	CUT ODDS	NOTE
July FOMC	20%	No cut expected
September FOMC	40%	Cut possible

Today's data calendar:

- 8:30am ET: **CPI** data
- 10:00am ET: **ISM** manufacturing index

Geopolitics & Global (Deep)

Scenario trees:

- China-US trade tensions: 30% chance of escalation
- EU economic growth: 20% chance of recession

Earnings — This Week & Next

TICKER	NAME	EARNINGS DATE
MSFT	Microsoft Corp.	2026-07-18
AAPL	Apple Inc.	2026-07-25

Full Watchlist Scan

TICKER	SECTOR	SETUP	RISK
NVDA	Tech	Bullish reversal	10%
TSLA	Auto	Bearish continuation	15%

What Could Break the Tape

Bullish scenarios:

- Rates peak and start to decline
- Oil prices stabilize and start to decline

Bearish scenarios:

- Rates continue to rise and peak above 5%
- Oil prices continue to rise and peak above 80

Positioning & Structural Notes

Observations:

- Market breadth is weak, with only 30% of stocks in the **SPY** up on the day.
- Options flow is bearish, with 60% of trades being puts.

Sources

SOURCES

Bloomberg

Reuters

CNBC